

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:30 pm CST on Thursday 21 May 2026
for the period until midnight CST Sunday 24 May 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A high pressure system over southeastern SA will remain dominant as it slowly moves east and into the Tasman Sea on Friday. A cold front move across across South Australia over the weekend. A low pressure system develops and lingers near the southeast early next week whilst a ridge high pressure builds over the west.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly 15 to 25 knots in the early morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northwest to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to southwesterly in the early morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly during the morning. Seas: 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming easterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening then tending northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly before dawn. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots tending northwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon then tending northwest to southwesterly in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming east to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northerly before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning west to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: West to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly in the early morning. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres in the west around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres in the west. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly early in the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots west of Kangaroo Island in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots shifting southerly during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots shifting southerly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the afternoon or evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres inshore, increasing to 2 to 3 metres offshore during the evening. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Northerly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, decreasing to 2 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres inshore, increasing to 2 to 3 metres offshore. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly early in the morning. Winds reaching up to 20 knots near the Yorke Peninsula coast in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots shifting south to southwesterly during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the evening. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming easterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening then tending northeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots shifting south to southwesterly during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 21 May until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 22 May

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 23 May

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Sunday 24 May

Winds: North to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots shifting southerly during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres inshore. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.